

TOPIC 2: EFFECTIVE OFFICE PRACTICE I – THE OFFICE

1. Meaning of an Office

An office is a place where the administrative and clerical work of an organisation is carried out. It is where information is received, processed, recorded, stored and communicated to help the organisation achieve its goals.

2. Types of Offices

- **Small office** – few staff, simple organisation (e.g. a small shop's office)
- **Large office** – many departments and staff (e.g. bank, ministry, big company)
- **Open-plan office** – large space with few partitions; staff work in the same area
- **Closed / Cellular office** – separate rooms for individuals or small groups
- **Virtual / Home office** – work done from home using computers and the internet

3. Functions of an Office

- Receiving and sending information (letters, emails, calls)
- Recording and storing information (files, databases)
- Processing information (preparing reports, accounts)
- Communicating within and outside the organisation
- Planning, organising and controlling activities
- Providing a place for meetings and decision-making
- Handling correspondence and visitors

4. Summary

An office is the administrative centre of an organisation. Offices can be small or large, open or closed. Their main functions are to receive, process, store and communicate information so that the organisation can run smoothly.

End of Topic 2